

PHOTOS: GETTY IMAGES

SPAIN

Vineyards, olive groves and mountain roads connect villages such as Gratallops and Porrera that are great for cycling, while neighbouring Montsant and Terra Alta regions offer hiking trails through rugged wine country. The Mosel River makes a natural wine trail, with cycling routes and Riesling stops on the German side, and vineyards easily explored on foot or by bicycle on the Luxembourg side.

PORTUGAL

Begin by taking the train from Porto towards Pinhão which follows the river and winds through one of Europe's most dramatic vineyard landscapes. You can continue by boat, passing steep terraces where Port and Douro wines are produced, and stop at a quinta for a tasting. The combination of train, river and vineyard makes the route as memorable as the wine.

CALIFORNIA, USA

Napa offers a more leisurely version of rail travel. The Napa Valley Wine Train runs between Napa and St Helena, combining historic rail cars, food and wine with views of the valley. It is also a reminder that a wine trail does not always mean driving from one tasting room to another. Napa and neighbouring Sonoma are also ideal for longer trips to explore wine beyond the main estates.

SOUTH AFRICA

This region has taken the hop-on, hop-off idea and made it distinctly wine-country. Moving through the valley, stopping at estates where you can get off for a tasting, lunch, cellar visit or a walk between the vines before catching the next tram. The surrounding Cape Winelands also make a good wine trail, particularly around Stellenbosch, Franschhoek and Paarl.



"Dramatic landscapes, historic villages, wine estates, restaurants, and vineyard trails offer more than just a view and a glass of vino."

Clockwise from facing page, top: A vineyard in Marlborough Wine Region in New Zealand's South Island; wine trams in Groot Drakenstein in South Africa's Western Cape that take tourists sightseeing; a Tuscan wine cellar